ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** nomination of candidates	Parties muster support
2	**(a)** Islam	India has no state religion
3	**(d)** Scandinavian countries	Sweden, Norway and Finland
4	**(a)** Panchayati Raj bodies	One-third of seats
5	**(a)** untouchability	The Constitution bans it
6	**(b)** equal rights and opportunities for women and men	Both women and men can be feminists
7	**(c)** women	This is the sexual division of labour
8	**(a)** B.R. Ambedkar	Also Jotiba Phule and Periyar
9	**(c)** communal riots and massacre	India and Pakistan saw them at Partition
10	**(d)** patriarchy	Women face disadvantages in such a system

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Scheduled Tribes (1); Communities that led a secluded life in hills and forests (1).	1+1
12	The idea that religion is the principal basis of community (1); Followers of one religion are believed to have the same interests (1).	1+1
13	Social exclusion of 'outcaste' groups (1); It is banned by the Constitution (1).	1+1
14	One-third of seats (1); In panchayats and municipalities (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	One-third seats in panchayats and municipalities (1); More than 10 lakh women representatives (1); Greater voice and visibility (1).	1+1+1
16	Voting rights for women (1); Higher political and legal status (1); Better education and career opportunities (1).	1+1+1
17	Diverts attention from poverty, development and corruption (1); Leads to tensions and conflict (1); Divides people (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Laws on marriage, divorce, adoption and inheritance (1); Different laws apply to followers of different religions (1); The women's movement says they discriminate against women (1).	1+1+1
18	Choice of candidates (1); Appeal to caste sentiment (1); Distribution of government posts among castes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: No party wins all the votes of a caste (1); Many parties field candidates of the same caste (1); Voters of the same caste differ by economic condition (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	No official religion (1); Freedom to profess, practise and propagate any religion or none (1); Prohibition of discrimination on religious grounds (1); State may intervene for equality within communities (1); Contrast with Sri Lanka, Pakistan and England (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Poverty is higher among STs and SCs than among upper castes (1); ST rural poverty 45.8 per cent (1); SC rural poverty 35.9 per cent (1); Hindu upper castes 11.7 per cent in rural areas (1); Average economic status follows the old hierarchy (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Lower literacy than men (1); Fewer girls in higher education (1); Lower wages for the same work (1); Declining child sex ratio (1); Harassment and violence (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: 14.36 per cent in Lok Sabha in 2019 (1); Less than 5 per cent in State Assemblies (1); One-third seats in local bodies (1); Over 10 lakh women in local bodies (1); 33 per cent reservation in Parliament and Assemblies by the 2023 Act (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying that gender division is **biological**: the chapter stresses that it is based on social expectations and stereotypes, not on biology.
- Mixing up **sexual division of labour** (work split by gender) with 'sex ratio' (number of females per 1000 males).
- Writing that India has an official religion; India is a **secular state**, with no religion given special status.
- Thinking that **communalism** means practising a religion; it means using religion as the basis of politics and treating one's own religion as superior.
- Claiming that caste alone decides how people vote; the chapter shows that **caste is only one factor** and voters also consider party and performance.
- Believing that caste has disappeared with urbanisation; caste inequality continues, though it has weakened, and **caste in politics** can help as well as harm.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** not changed much	Population grew but proportions are stable
2	**(a)** Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam	Passed in 2023
3	**(c)** all members of a caste think alike politically	The chapter shows this is wrong
4	**(c)** the religion of every citizen	It is done every ten years
5	**(c)** mobilise and secure political support	It also brought new consciousness among low castes
6	**(b)** space to demand their share of power	Dalits and OBCs gained access
7	**(d)** no religion	It is a secular Constitution
8	**(b)** not valued as much as it should be	Household work is unpaid
9	**(d)** Hindus	About 79.8 per cent in 2011
10	**(c)** occupational mobility	Old notions of caste are breaking down

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Women do the household work or organise it (1); Men do the work outside the home (1).	1+1
12	Scheduled Castes (1); Groups previously treated as 'outcaste' (1).	1+1
13	Number of girl children per thousand boys (1); Parents prefer sons and use sex-selective abortion (1).	1+1
14	A hierarchical social division seen everywhere (1); It is based on social expectations, not biology (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	SC 16.6 per cent and ST 8.6 per cent (1); OBC about 41 per cent (1); Together about two-thirds of the population (1).	1+1+1
16	Upper castes best off and Dalits and Adivasis worst off (1); Higher proportion of poor among lowest castes (1); Upper castes over-represented among the rich (1).	1+1+1
17	Disadvantaged groups get space to demand their share (1); Dalits and OBCs gain access to decision making (1); Organisations demand dignity and access to land and opportunities (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It makes religion the sole basis of community (1); It leads to violence and hatred (1); It threatens the idea of equal citizens (1).	1+1+1
18	Hereditary occupational divisions sanctioned by rituals (1); Marriage within the caste and no eating with other castes (1); Exclusion of 'outcaste' groups by untouchability (1).	1+1+1
	OR: 14.36 per cent in the Lok Sabha in 2019 (1); Less than 5 per cent in State Assemblies (1); India is in the bottom group of countries (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Caste groups expand to include neighbouring castes (1); Castes enter coalitions with others (1); New groups like backward and forward castes come up (1); It is the caste that gets politicised, not politics that becomes caste-ridden (1); Disadvantaged groups get a platform (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Gender and caste politics can help disadvantaged groups gain voice (1); Communal politics pits religions against each other (1); Exclusive caste attention diverts attention from poverty (1); Healthy expression gives space to demands without hostility (1); Unhealthy expression leads to conflict (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Religion is treated as the basis of the nation or community (1); One religion is pitted against another (1); State power used for dominance (1); Leads to riots and violence (1); Threatens democracy and equality (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Parties choose candidates considering caste composition (1); Appeals to caste sentiment (1); Governments include different castes (1); Universal adult franchise made leaders seek support (1); New consciousness among low castes (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying that gender division is **biological**: the chapter stresses that it is based on social expectations and stereotypes, not on biology.
- Mixing up **sexual division of labour** (work split by gender) with 'sex ratio' (number of females per 1000 males).
- Writing that India has an official religion; India is a **secular state**, with no religion given special status.
- Thinking that **communalism** means practising a religion; it means using religion as the basis of politics and treating one's own religion as superior.
- Claiming that caste alone decides how people vote; the chapter shows that **caste is only one factor** and voters also consider party and performance.
- Believing that caste has disappeared with urbanisation; caste inequality continues, though it has weakened, and **caste in politics** can help as well as harm.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 15: **Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Dalits	Previously treated as outcaste
2	**(a)** Buddhism	Contrast with India
3	**(d)** Adivasis	They led a secluded life in hills and forests
4	**(c)** caste is not the only factor in voting	There is no complete 'vote bank'
5	**(b)** communalism	It is a major challenge to democracy
6	**(c)** hereditary	Sanctioned by rituals
7	**(b)** secular	To face communalism
8	**(a)** 1976	It provides equal wages for equal work
9	**(c)** child sex ratio	It has declined in India
10	**(d)** India	Gender and religion divisions are found elsewhere too

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The Equal Remuneration Act (1); It was passed in 1976 (1).	1+1
12	A caste group tries to include neighbouring castes or sub-castes (1); This makes the group bigger (1).	1+1
13	No official religion (1); Freedom to follow any religion or none (1).	1+1
14	Equal rights and opportunities for women and men (1); Equality in personal and family life too (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Sex-selective abortion (1); Harassment and exploitation (1); Domestic violence and unsafe urban areas (1).	1+1+1
16	Women's main role was seen as housework (1); Earlier only men could participate in public affairs and vote (1); Women's work is unpaid and not valued (1).	1+1+1
17	Everyday religious prejudices (1); Political dominance of own religion (1); Mobilisation on religious lines and violence (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Women's literacy is 54 per cent against 76 per cent for men (1); Fewer girls go for higher studies (1); Women are paid less than men for the same work (1).	1+1+1
18	No official religion (1); Freedom to profess, practise and propagate any religion (1); No discrimination on religious grounds (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Economic development and urbanisation (1); Growth of literacy and occupational mobility (1); Weakening of landlords and the Constitution's ban on caste discrimination (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hereditary occupational division with rituals and untouchability (1); Reformers like Phule, Gandhi, Ambedkar and Periyar worked against it (1); Urbanisation and literacy weakened hierarchy (1); Constitution prohibits discrimination (1); Yet caste still persists in marriage and economic status (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Based on social expectations and stereotypes (1); Boys and girls are taught different roles (1); Women do housework, men work outside (1); Men do paid housework jobs like tailors and cooks (1); Women work in fields and offices too (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	The Census records the religion of every person (1); Hindus 79.8, Muslims 14.2, Christians 2.3, Sikhs 1.7 per cent (1); Proportions have not changed much since Independence (1); Sachar Committee estimates show only a small rise for Muslims (1); The belief that one community will overtake others is mistaken (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: No constituency has a clear majority of one caste (1); No party wins all votes of a caste (1); Several parties may field candidates of the same caste (1); Ruling parties often lose (1); Performance and leaders also matter (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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